3.11 Pulmonary Embolism

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • "I suddenly could not breathe and my chest hurts." **Objective** • SpO_2 87% • HR 124/min, RR 32/min • Anxious and sweating	**ACTUAL** **Impaired gas exchange** related to ventilation–perfusion mismatch as evidenced by sudden dyspnea, hypoxemia and tachycardia.	SpO_2 94% or more within 6 hours.	• Give oxygen as prescribed. • Sit him in high Fowler. • Continuous monitoring of SpO_2, ECG and vital signs. • Give the anticoagulant or thrombolytic as prescribed. • Get him ready for CT pulmonary angiography.	SpO_2 on target, less breathless: **goal met**.
Subjective • "I feel I am going to die." **Objective** • Restless • Shaking	**ACTUAL** **Fear** related to sudden breathlessness and chest pain as evidenced by expressed fear and restlessness.	Says he is less frightened within 2 hours.	• Stay with him. • Explain each procedure briefly and calmly. • Give analgesia as prescribed.	Calmer: **goal met**.
Subjective • *No specific complaint* **Objective** • On heparin or another anticoagulant	**RISK** **Risk for bleeding** as evidenced by risk factors: anticoagulant or thrombolytic therapy.	No bleeding, and clotting results in the therapeutic range.	• Check aPTT or INR as ordered. • Look for bleeding from the gums, urine, stool and puncture sites. • No IM injections. • Keep the antidote available as policy requires.	No bleeding: **goal met**.